

Installing Conduit

Conduit is not available as a binary package for many popular distributions, and in most cases you will have to install it from source. Download the Conduit source tarball from <http://live.gnome.org/Conduit>. Then, as the root, issue the following command to unpack, build and install Conduit:

```
tar xvfz conduit-<current_version_number>
```

This will extract Conduit in the current directory, in a folder named `conduit-<current_version_number>`. Once you change the working directory to this directory, if you wish to try out Conduit without installing it, run the following code:

```
cd conduit
./conduit
```

At this point, you should know something about Conduit: it installs fine even if you don't have all the necessary components (for example, Web-Kit—without which you cannot use any service that needs authentication; even then, Conduit installs without any problems). The dependencies required by Conduit are:

- `gocanvas > 0.9.0`
- `pygocanvas`
- `vobject`
- `gtkmazembed` (packaged as `gnome-python-extras`)
- Python `elementtree` or Python 2.5
- Python `sqlite3` (packaged as `pysqlite2`) or Python 2.5
- `evolution-python`

I strongly recommend that you use pre-built binary packages for your distribution, if they are available. Compiling from source can lead to *dependency hell* unless you know exactly what you are doing. To install Conduit, in the top-level directory (`conduit-<current_version_number>`), issue the following commands:

```
./configure
make && make install
```

Note: At the end of the `configure` script's execution, it will list some plug-ins as disabled. Generally, there is no need to enable these plug-ins, as there is no significant advantage in having them. If you want to enable and install them, then enter the following arguments while running `./configure`.

```
./configure --enable-eog-plugin --enable-totem-plugin \
--enable-nautilus-extension
```

That's it. Conduit is now installed, with the executable installed into `/usr/local/bin`.

Notice the small blue arrows shown near the icons in the left pane; they indicate whether the service can synchronise bi-directionally or not. At the bottom of the canvas, there is an expandable menu for conflicts. It will get activated in case the rules you define for synchronisation cause conflicts with each other.

Simple example

Let's start with a very simple example. We can assume that you want to synchronise two directories—one on your computer hard drive, the second on some back-up media. Start Conduit, and then drag the *Folder* option from the services pane to the canvas. After that, drag another instance of the same *Folder* option right next to the first one. Double-click each *Folder* service provider that you dropped on the canvas, to configure its details. You can

then add the directory path, and other options for synchronisation.

You can define synchronisation rules by right-clicking the current group and configuring options under the *Synchronisation Options* tab. To synchronise the two directories that we configured earlier, just right-click the group and select the *Synchronise Group* option.

Services that require authentication

Let's consider an example where one of the data services requires authentication before Conduit can proceed. For instance, let's suppose I want to synchronise all my photos between my Facebook account and the local F-Spot database. Remember, Facebook does not allow downloading of photos; you can only upload them. As in the previous case, place both Facebook and F-Spot service providers on the canvas, in the